

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, MA 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, October 21, 2014

The meeting convened at 7:00 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Thomas Cleary, Jr., Maryanne Duggan, Aniko Giordano, Margaret Parsons, Joseph Pipczynski, Celeste Whiting, Ed Zawacki.

1. Vote to accept minutes of FinCom meeting of 9/23/14 as amended. Vote 8-0-0.

2. Old Business:

Town Audit: Margie reported that Cheryl's and Anne Marie's efforts in preparing for the town audit were very important. The town finances are in good order. Margie, in her role as interim accountant, is reviewing and correcting the books for the last two months.

New Growth: Dolores reports there is \$47,000 in new growth. We had budgeted \$25,000 for new growth. This took care of our budget deficit.

Free Cash: Margie reports that we have \$90,000 coming back from various departments which will all go to free cash.

3. Other issues brought before the Finance Committee.

We discussed a transfer request of \$2,112 to be transferred from the Reserve Fund to Veterans Expense due to an additional Veteran qualifying for benefits. We voted 9-1-0 to approve the transfer.

We noted that a town meeting is necessary to vote to have these funds for veterans benefits come from Free Cash in the future as this recurring expense will deplete the Reserve Fund in the coming months.

We voted 10-0-0 to transfer \$185.00 from the Board of Health Salary to the Health Agent.

4. Old Business Continued.

We continued our review of the FY15 budget process. Aniko and Mary presented a draft form to use for department budget requests for FY16. We discussed and would like to

adopt it with some amendments. We would also like to provide a sample department budget as guidance for departments for the budget process this year. We noted that FinCom would like all departments to understand that the Finance Committee is their advocate and the more detail we receive, the better we will be able to advocate for each department.

We noted that the Westhampton Elementary School is looking for budget guidelines from FinCom.

5. New Business:

Accounts Payable Clerk: We noted that a notice has been posted for the hiring of an Accounts Payable Clerk. The posting closes on Nov. 4 and that candidates will be chosen for interviews on Nov. 17. Celeste will attend the Selectboard meeting when these interviews take place.

Ellice noted that there will be a preliminary review of the FY2016 budgeting process at the Hampshire Regional School District meeting on Tuesday, November 4 at 6:00 pm.

Due to the late hour, Celeste's presentation of her interview with the Pelham Finance Committee was postponed again. We look forward to hearing her presentation at the next meeting.

We scheduled the next meeting for Tuesday, Nov. 11 at 7:00 pm.

The meeting adjourned at 8:50.

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary.